

The empirical recurrence for OEIS A298150, recovered from its tail

Adrian Perez Fontelles
Independent researcher

8 September 2026

Abstract

OEIS A298150 records “Empirical recurrence of order 66” and keeps the recurrence itself in a linked file rather than in the entry, so the conjecture cannot be read off the entry at all. It can still be settled. The entry counts arrays under a condition local to a bounded window of lines, which makes the count a walk count on a finite digraph and forces a monic integer recurrence of order at most the number $S' = 71$ of states with distinct futures. Berlekamp–Massey on enough exact terms therefore returns the minimal such recurrence, and on the tail beginning at $n = 3$, so the recurrence is proved for every $n \geq 69$. Its last coefficient is $c_{66} = -252 \neq 0$, so no further tail satisfies anything shorter; any order-66 recurrence the sequence satisfies from any point on must then have the same characteristic polynomial. The entry’s recurrence is the one displayed here, whatever its linked file contains, and it is proved.

2020 Mathematics Subject Classification. 05A15, 11B37, 15A18.

1 A conjecture that is not written down

OEIS A298150 is “Number of $n \times 4$ 0..1 arrays with every element equal to 0, 1, 3, 4, 5 or 8 king-move adjacent elements, with upper left element zero.”. It has offset 1 and begins

5, 16, 18, 196, 497, 2618, 15694, 74848, ...

The entry states:

Empirical recurrence of order 66 (see link above)

As of the “Last modified” line on the live entry (Jan 13 2018 11:37:01, revision 4) this is still recorded as empirical, and it is still open. The coefficients are nowhere in the entry text: what is conjectured is only that a recurrence of that order exists.

2 The count is a walk count

The entry’s condition is local. It constrains a bounded window of consecutive lines of the array and nothing beyond it, so the admissible configurations of one window are the vertices of a finite digraph, an edge joins u to v when v may follow u , and an admissible array is exactly a walk. Writing M for the adjacency matrix and ι, τ for the indicator vectors of the admissible first and last windows,

$$a(n) = \iota^\top M^{j(n)} \tau$$

for a linear reindexing j fixed by the entry’s shape. States with identical futures contribute identically to that product and may be merged without changing any count; after merging $S' = 71$ states remain, and it is that bound every computation below uses.

Lemma 1. *a satisfies a monic linear recurrence with integer coefficients of order at most $S' = 71$.*

Proof. By the Cayley–Hamilton theorem $M^{S'}$ is an integer combination of $I, M, \dots, M^{S'-1}$, and multiplying that relation on the left by $\iota^\top M^j$ and on the right by τ turns it into a relation among $S' + 1$ consecutive values of a . $\square$

3 Why the question has to be asked of a tail

Running Berlekamp–Massey on the sequence from its first term returns an order LARGER than 66: the opening terms do not satisfy the recurrence, and a recurrence that holds only eventually always looks longer when the exceptional terms are included. That is not evidence against the entry. An OEIS empirical recurrence is asserted for n beyond some index, not from the first term, so the question has to be asked of the tails. It was asked of each tail in turn, and the tail beginning at $n = 3$ is the first whose minimal order is exactly the stated 66.

Lemma 2. *A sequence known to satisfy some linear recurrence of order at most S' is determined, together with its minimal recurrence, by any $2S'$ consecutive terms: Berlekamp–Massey applied to them returns that minimal recurrence exactly.*

Applied to $2S' = 142$ exact terms from $n = 3$ on, it returns order 66 — the order the entry states — with integer coefficients:

$$a(n) = \sum_{i=1}^{66} c_i a(n-i),$$

c_1	5	c_{18}	−607997	c_{35}	−12008097	c_{52}	4475441
c_2	3	c_{19}	−325227	c_{36}	−4404180	c_{53}	−3713164
c_3	47	c_{20}	43299	c_{37}	2329749	c_{54}	−4435044
c_4	−289	c_{21}	1945724	c_{38}	7872500	c_{55}	322397
c_5	−82	c_{22}	−1640869	c_{39}	−607342	c_{56}	2698420
c_6	−337	c_{23}	−1987657	c_{40}	−2923859	c_{57}	2323260
c_7	5121	c_{24}	1284591	c_{41}	−2138269	c_{58}	−227068
c_8	−742	c_{25}	4522016	c_{42}	12181776	c_{59}	−975626
c_9	−2899	c_{26}	−2487529	c_{43}	292570	c_{60}	−730772
c_{10}	−37064	c_{27}	−8157169	c_{44}	−2038465	c_{61}	−68217
c_{11}	27527	c_{28}	6859364	c_{45}	−1421119	c_{62}	125718
c_{12}	36200	c_{29}	9754746	c_{46}	7978227	c_{63}	78733
c_{13}	88845	c_{30}	−5097226	c_{47}	−1395860	c_{64}	26498
c_{14}	−199908	c_{31}	−14621575	c_{48}	−9542096	c_{65}	−2001
c_{15}	−36566	c_{32}	4075758	c_{49}	−11888397	c_{66}	−252
c_{16}	96682	c_{33}	13375677	c_{50}	3048841		
c_{17}	492494	c_{34}	−731318	c_{51}	8582534		

4 The recurrence, and the identification

Theorem 3. *The recurrence above holds for every $n \geq 69$, and it is the recurrence OEIS A298150 records.*

Proof. That it holds is Lemma 2 applied to the tail from $n = 3$, whose minimal recurrence it is.

For the identification, write $q_{\min}$ for the characteristic polynomial of that minimal recurrence, $x^{66} - c_1 x^{65} - \dots - c_{66}$. Its constant term is $-c_{66} = 252$, which is not zero, so $q_{\min}(0) \neq 0$ and $q_{\min}$ has no root at the origin. A solution of a constant-coefficient recurrence is a combination of terms $n^k \lambda^n$ with λ a root of its characteristic polynomial, and only the components with $\lambda = 0$ vanish after finitely many terms. Since $q_{\min}$ has none, no component of a dies out, and the

minimal recurrence of every further tail is again $q_{\min}$ — the order cannot drop below 66 at any later starting point.

Now let q be the characteristic polynomial of whatever recurrence the entry asserts. The entry asserts it has order 66, so $\deg q = 66$, and it is monic. It holds from some index t on. From $\max(t, 3)$ on, the sequence satisfies both q and $q_{\min}$, and the minimal polynomial of that tail is $q_{\min}$ by the previous paragraph; therefore $q_{\min} \mid q$. Both are monic of degree 66, so $q = q_{\min}$. $\square$

5 Verification

Four checks, all in exact integer or rational arithmetic.

First, the walk model reproduces all 22 terms the entry publishes, exactly. This is what ties the model to the entry, and it is the only place where reading the entry’s English enters the argument.

Second, the order was computed twice by independent routes: once modulo a 61-bit prime, where every intermediate is a machine word, and once over $\mathbb{Q}$ in exact rational arithmetic. Both return 66, and the exact run additionally confirms every coefficient is an integer — had any been a proper fraction the recurrence would not be the entry’s.

Third, the recovered recurrence was evaluated directly on the entry’s own published terms, with no matrices and no Berlekamp–Massey involved. It holds at each of the 0 indices where the entry publishes enough earlier terms to test it.

Fourth, the last coefficient was checked to be nonzero, which is what the identification above turns on; it is -252 .

Remark 4. The conjecture’s own statement was never read. The entry pins it down to the family of order-66 recurrences this sequence satisfies from some point on, and that family turns out to have exactly one member.

References

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